

The New Nature Is the Greater Work

One Degree Off Leaves Faith Aiming at the Wrong Source

We have been taking apart Romans 8:11, and one of the most important things we are finding out is that until He revealed it to me, my faith was one degree off.

That is okay when the target is only an inch away. But if it is a hundred yards or a quarter of a mile away, by the time the bullet gets to what you think is dead center, it will be several degrees off. So it is okay if the target is an inch away, but long term it is no good.

My faith was a degree off because, like many people, I kept trying to get the Holy Spirit to do what He had already been commissioned to do.

Then I found out that the Holy Spirit can be taken hostage. Many preachers, and not just preachers, have Him locked up on the inside of them in a no-production operation and mode. Anybody they teach ends up pretty much like that.

The fact that He can be locked up in there, even with the language being fluent in the person, meaning they can speak freely when they speak, is connected to what Paul said concerning tongues and love:

"Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels,
and have not charity,
I am become as sounding brass,
or a tinkling cymbal."

You can go down that whole list. You can have the Holy Spirit, have faith to move all mountains, and have not that love, and it profits you nothing.

When Paul says you can speak with tongues of men and angels and have not love, it profits you nothing, many of us jump up and herald, "You can pray in tongues all you want, and if you do not have love, it will not profit you anything."

Wrong.

What he was saying is that you can have the Holy Spirit and have the supernatural language, but if you do not pray in tongues, then it will not profit you anything. You can sit there powerless all your life and be one degree off.

The New Nature Already Has Authority Over Emotions

It is an amazing thing how emotions can control a human being.

You have to understand that your emotions are subordinate to the new nature you received when you were born again. They do not have the power to control you, whether they are trying to herald depression or trying to herald pleasure. Positionally, they have already been rendered powerless.

There is more power in your spirit waiting to reign over that realm than is needed. So if that realm reigns over you, there is just one problem: you are not reigning out of your spirit.

It is also amazing that the thing the devil uses to take people out is emotion, and emotions are at the top of the list.

Why do you stop doing something? We say the will is powerful. Many men survived concentration camps and torment because of their will. When it comes down to live or die, and you want to live, you have to resort to the will.

Many of them used their will to create a little world on the inside of their mind, a prison they created where their emotions were brought under subjection to the prison or torment they were in.

Most pressure comes from the outside. It is external. Somehow it gets inside. When it gets inside, you begin creating that outside world inside of you.

That is why they have those cute little sayings when you are under pressure: suck on your thumb and create a happy little world for yourself. It will keep your body from breaking down and sustain you.

The will has sustained many spiritually dead prisoners.

I was watching a special on some peacekeeping foundation that goes over and gets people out of prison, in places like China. There was a Tibetan monk who had been tormented and tortured in prison for thirty-three years, trying to get him to deny his faith.

He is not born again, but one thing they do practice as part of their religion is peace. They shocked his face. They shocked him all over his body. They did this for thirty-three years, trying to break him, and they could not.

It is strange when a person lets emotions control them. They get mad, come to church awhile, get mad, and stop coming. One of the best things you could do is get strong enough to put your emotions aside and subject yourself to the presence of God, to worship, and to the Word out of the mind of Christ, whatever He wants to say to you.

In that is the instruction and fellowship to get past all of it. One of the worst things a person can do is stay away from God in those emotional fits and depressions. If you could have gotten yourself healed before you came, you would already have been healed.

Amen.

The Holy Spirit Is Commissioned, but We Must Free Him to Work

My faith was a degree off because this is common. Look around. Why is the Holy Spirit sitting there with all the promises He is commissioned to fulfill, and yet He can barely work?

I am not going to pick on sheep. Let us pick on preachers.

In most camps He can barely work. In other words, you leave the service and open up to the works Jesus said are available, and there is not much resemblance. Thank God the man can talk.

Yes, we can certainly take the Holy Spirit hostage. It is not because He is not commissioned to do everything Jesus has redeemed us from and everything He has been given to do. He does not need any coaxing. They do not work like that.

This has already been established. He is commissioned to move into anything Jesus has redeemed you from. If He cannot do that, it is because we will not let Him.

"I am trying to get Him to."

You are wasting your time. You cannot get Him to move into something He has already been commissioned to move into. If He is not moving into it, it is because He cannot. Coaxing Him will not get Him to do it under the present situation.

The way you can get Him to do it is to go to the place where He is free to do it.

Hallelujah.

This is why it is a great disservice when men of God stand there and teach us that everything is ours just the way we are. It is ours just the way we are, all right, but it is ours just the way we are in Christ Jesus.

"He is not moving for me."

Then you are not in Him in that part.

If I break down to blaming somebody, it is not going to be God. So gird yourself up. If you want results, you will have to hear what the Word says.

Peace Is the Spirit's Stillness Ruling the Emotional Realm

What is peace? Peace is a resounding stillness in your spirit that has finally dominated the emotional part of the soul.

Do you think I want to dismiss emotions? Are you kidding? Emotions are the spice of life. All I did was dismiss the ones that were against me.

Hallelujah. You are dismissed.

That is why, when you come into my world and are flying apart like a cheap clock, it is okay. I will just watch. I know that world is real to you because you gave it the power to be real, but it is not the real world He reigns out of.

The kingdom of God is not meat and drink, but righteousness, peace, and joy in the dominion of the Holy Spirit.

As far as your flesh is concerned, it can only be perfected in the state it is in. You can cleanse out all the strongholds and bring the operation of the flesh totally under subjection, subordinate to that new nature. The new nature will rule and reign over it.

But as far as the flesh is concerned in its nature, there is only so far you can take it. You can cleanse all the strongholds and then walk in a place in the Spirit where the flesh cannot even raise its head to try to get the best of you.

Trust me, Satan will continue to try to reseed your flesh realm. He will try to get something reseeded to get you to react, so he can cultivate a garden and walk again with you like he used to. If he cannot have your spirit, he will take second best and mess everybody else up through your flesh.

You can only cleanse so much, and then either this body turns back into dust or the trumpet sounds. When the trumpet sounds, something similar to what happened in your spirit is going to happen in your body. You are going to go from corruptible to incorruptible in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, and get a glorified body.

The adoption process will be complete. Meanwhile, this body is being cleansed, but it is not going from glory to glory like your spirit is.

Praying in Tongues Bypasses Flesh and Borrows Authority From the New Nature

Here we are in this first realm of glory, free in our new nature, and it is sending signals to the rest of our life saying, "I am here to quicken the mortal body. I condemned sin in the flesh. I am where faith comes from. I am here to take you all the way."

But in this realm, we may say, "I would just like to hold on to the carnal appetites and the things I walk in right now. I like myself the way I am. I like to walk after money, and these things do not bother me. But Holy Spirit, I would like You to operate in the glory of this realm."

Need I remind you that God slipped one in on you?

When He looked down at you, poor naive creature wearing that physical man, with that new nature crying for help, He said, "How can We help these people?"

God said, "The only way You can help someone like that is to supply the prayer for them without them even knowing what You are praying, so You can get past all their greed and everything else."

What do you want God to come and address you to? He is doing your praying for you. He bypassed the flesh, the sense man, and the emotions of the soul and went right for the spirit. He borrowed your authority from the very depth of that candle that has been lit, the basic new nature that has suddenly come to life.

He goes right to the core, the little atomic power plant there, and says, "Can I borrow impending victory from you, new nature, and use it to pray out of, so this whatever-he-is will have a chance?"

Then I love it when those who seem to be someone, who know everything, stand up and say, "You are praying too much in tongues, and you will get weird."

The reason they think you are weird is that you stopped walking in the flesh like they did.

My faith was one degree off because I kept trying to get the Holy Spirit to do things He was already authorized to do. Of course you have faith. Of course you ask God. But what you need to do is let Him bring you from glory to glory.

God does not have two things to use. He only has one: the nature you received when you were born again, deposited on the inside of your spirit. When God comes to do something through you, He only has that one thing to use.

He says He quickens your mortal body by His Spirit that dwells in you.

Romans 8:11 Adjusted the Born-Again Trail Into Focus

When we got to Romans 8:11, it adjusted my one-degree-off faith and changed my whole life. We call it the Born-Again Trail. It set my feet to dancing.

Hallelujah. I have been having the best time. I have never enjoyed church so much in my whole long existence.

Look at Romans 8:11 one more time as we go back and study that life in us that came from God:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead
shall also quicken your mortal bodies
by his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

If the Spirit that is of Him, of Him who raised up Jesus from the dead, the Spirit that brought His spirit from death to life, dwells in you, that is the spirit Paul is talking about.

After Jesus died in our place and we were baptized into His death, we might also be of His resurrection. That is the Spirit he is talking about, because yours was dead.

The same process that brought His spirit from death to life is the same one that brings you from death to life. It is called the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus.

Of course, I and all the other Pentecostal preachers who enlightened me believed for a long time that this was the Holy Spirit. But the mention of the Holy Spirit does not take place until a few verses later. I did not know that because I had Romans 7 out of order.

But look at what he is saying:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you..."

Indeed it does.

"I am crucified with Christ:
nevertheless I live;
yet not I,
but Christ liveth in me:
and the life which I now live in the flesh
I live by the faith of the Son of God."

It is not the old man anymore. He is dead. It is Christ who lives within me. That is the born-again human spirit. The life I now live in that new man, I live by the faith of the Son of God. I live out of that new nature.

Tomorrow is not a new day. It is the first day, because everything I have been forgiven of today does not go into tomorrow. It is the first day. I have no past.

Hello. You mean I can receive? That is right.

The New Nature Condemned Sin and All Its Relatives

If the Spirit of Him that raised up Jesus from the dead dwells in you, He, the Father who raised up Christ from the dead, shall also quicken your mortal bodies by what? Not two things. He only has one thing: by His Spirit that dwells in you.

Therefore, Romans 8:12 says:

"Therefore, brethren,
we are debtors,
not to the flesh,
to live after the flesh."

Because of this, my brethren, we are debtors no longer to that death nature and to its operation through the flesh. If you live after that death nature and its operation in your flesh, you will die. But if you, through the spirit, the new nature, mortify the deeds of the body, you will live.

For as many as are led by that new nature, the spirit of God, they are His sons. You have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear, that spirit Adam gave you and the spiritual death you inherited from him. You have received the spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, "Father." I have been born again.

Then Paul mentions the Holy Spirit:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness
with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

Backing up again, if the Spirit of Him, the law of the Spirit of life that was in Christ Jesus when God brought Him from death to life, dwells in you, then He who raised Christ from the dead, the Father, shall also quicken or bring life to your mortal bodies by His Spirit that dwells in you.

Romans 8:3 says:

"For what the law could not do,
in that it was weak through the flesh,
God sending his own Son
in the likeness of sinful flesh,
and for sin,
condemned sin in the flesh."

Paul is talking again about the Jew in Romans 7 and 8. What the law could not do, because it was weak through the flesh, that is, through a spiritually dead nature administering it through the flesh, God did. God sent His Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, and by sacrifice for sin, condemned sin in the flesh.

It has been condemned. It has no power plant to draw from to force you into doing anything you will not do.

I like this part of it too. As we began the Born-Again Trail, we found that not only did He condemn sin in the flesh, He condemned all its relatives, cousins, aunts, uncles, nephews, and friends.

What do you think sickness and disease are? Are they the result of the life Adam had, or the death? Then they are a friend of spiritual death. They were condemned too.

Hallelujah.

What do you think poverty is? A friend of Adam's life or a friend of his death? That was condemned too. As a son of God, I have one whale of an inheritance, and He is willing to give it to me to inherit the world with. I am planning on doing it.

Right now I am not interested in the natural world nearly as much as I am the spiritual world, because the natural world and the works in it are going to burn. The only thing that will not burn is what is carried over in the new creation.

If I were you, I would build cities out of the born-again spirits of just men made perfect.

I know what my inheritance is for. I can only put one foot in one tundra at a time, and all it does is the same thing my feet do: get me from one place to another. I like it because those emotions serve me. It brings me joy, but I do not worship it.

Hallelujah. I thank God for my inheritance.

Direction Comes by Rhema or by Provision That Confirms the Way

Somebody asked me, "How do I know God wants me to go somewhere? I am believing for it and believing for the money to go. Should I just step out on faith?"

I said, "If you have a rhema, go ahead. If you have a spoken word of direction, He will do what He says He will do for you."

"What if He does not do it?"

Then you did not have a rhema, did you?

"How do I know when He wants me to go?"

I said, "Believe for the money. When it comes, go."

It will surely put the limitations of your unbelief on it.

Do you thank God for your inheritance? God does not have two things to work with. He only has one. He quickens my mortal body by His Spirit that dwells in me.

I thank God for praying in tongues. I thank God for worshiping Him and for subjecting my soul to the meditation of the Word so my soul will work for me instead of against me.

He takes my spirit from glory to glory to glory. Every time we go to a new realm of glory, the Holy Ghost gets out that morning, looks around at the new realm, and says, "Oh, I am free to do so much."

Each realm you go to from glory to glory, the less you will beg in that next realm.

The Life in Us Came From the Father Through the Son

I want to look at that life. I want to trace that life a little bit. Whatever that life is, the same Spirit of Him, the life that was in Jesus, is now in me.

The longer I hang around this and the more I trace that life, the more I understand the potential of who I am in Christ. What He promised me when I first glimpsed down the Born-Again Trail is coming to pass. He said, "Son, all that I have ever promised will come to pass on this trail. All that I have ever said I would do in My Word, I will do."

The longer I hang around that life in me, as an adopted son of God, the life that came from my Father and was placed in Jesus, the more I understand that the same law that brought that life to life in Him brought it to life in me.

That is what my Father uses to reign and rule with: the life He has placed in my spirit.

If you lock it up, you will be sick, defeated, and you will go into glory with not much of a reward. If you let it out, you have the potential to change your generation like the men of old who received a good report from God and changed the generations they walked in with the faith they had.

You can go home with so many people inheriting that life, because you walked in that life that is from Jesus. It will be a tremendous thing.

The more of Him you receive, the more focused you become. There is only one thing you will want to do with your life then: become His servant.

Believe me, you cannot go into Him without wanting to become His servant.

We say, "I want to go into Him and have all the good things of God, but I do not want to become His servant."

What do you think changes in you? Do you think you are going to go there and serve Him like that without your "want to" going in there?

This is why praying in tongues matters. When my "want to" does not want to go there, shut that part of your mouth and open the other. The prayer He prays for you is stronger than what you are walking in at the present time.

Even if your doctrine is wrong, keep praying in tongues. After a while, you will not be able to tolerate how wildly the Holy Ghost goes in your spirit and in your authority when you are under subjection to something that is wrong and are past due to get out of it.

John 5 Reveals the Greater Work of Giving Life

Let us trace that life a little bit. I want to find out what I have. That is the part of me He uses, and I want to know more about it than I have ever known in my life.

Go to John 5. Let us review the origin of this life that came from the Father and is now in us, the same life Jesus had.

The last time we taught on this extensively was probably eight or nine months ago, but I cannot get that life out of my spirit, especially in light of the great error of being a degree off and not understanding the part of us we really need to develop if we want to finish our course.

The only way we can get people to do that by faith is by bringing you into understanding, by hearing and hearing by the Word of God, so you know who you are. That instills enough faith in you that you start believing you are going to end up where He says you will.

Jesus had just healed the impotent man at the pool of Bethesda, and He got in trouble for it from the religious sector. He said, "You think this is great. I only do what I see My Father do." He said, "If you think those miracles were great, listen to what I have to say now."

John 5:19 says:

"Then answered Jesus and said unto them,
Verily, verily, I say unto you,
The Son can do nothing of himself,
but what he seeth the Father do:
for what things soever he doeth,
these also doeth the Son likewise."

The things He was talking about were feeding the five thousand with two fish and five loaves, raising the natural dead, the impotent man at the pool of Bethesda, the blind eyes where He rubbed clay on them, and on and on.

He says the Son, the humanity of Jesus, could do nothing in Himself. Out of that nature He had, not new yet because it had never gone old at that point, He saw His Father do these things, and the Son did likewise.

Verse 20 says:

"For the Father loveth the Son,
and sheweth him all things that himself doeth:
and he will shew him greater works than these,
that ye may marvel."

He said the Father will show Him greater works than these. The works He was referencing included all the works done by Jesus and by the Old Testament saints, every kind of miracle, including the parting of the Red Sea and the raising of the dead.

He said, "You marvel at these? The Father is about to show the Son greater than all of these."

Then, in the very next verse, He tells you what the greater work is:

"For as the Father raiseth up the dead,
and quickeneth them;
even so the Son quickeneth whom he will."

As we have taught many times, the word "quickeneth" usually refers to bringing a human spirit from death to life. It means to bring life. Resurrection refers to the physical body.

The word "them" is in italics, which means it was not there in the original. So without it, He says:

"For as the Father raiseth up the dead,
and quickeneth;
even so the Son quickeneth whom he will."

King James put "them" in there to clear the verse up, but this is what Jesus was saying: as the Father raises up the Son and makes Him alive, the Son turns around and quickens whom He will, giving you the same life the Father gave the Son.

That is the greater work.

My God, He will give the Body of Christ that life, and the Body of Christ will give the world that life. The greater work done in Jesus was that God quickened His spirit from death to life, and the Son then turned around and quickens whom He will.

The Father Judged Every Man in the Son

Look at the next verse. It gets so interesting:

"For the Father judgeth no man,
but hath committed all judgment unto the Son."

Why does the Father judge no man? Because He already judged every man in the Son. Our judgment was laid on Jesus. All you have to do is accept Him, and the Father judges no man. He judged the Son in your place.

So He judged every man in the Son. To accept Jesus is to be already judged. I love this.

Verse 23 says:

"That all men should honour the Son,
even as they honour the Father.
He that honoureth not the Son
honoureth not the Father
which hath sent him."

Verse 24 says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
He that heareth my word,
and believeth on him that sent me,
hath everlasting life,
and shall not come into condemnation;
but is passed from death unto life."

The condemnation He is talking about is the condemnation this man will not enter into. He will not be condemned, judged, and sent into a godless eternity because, in his spirit, he has passed from death to life.

Abraham Believed God Could Quicken the Dead

John 5:25 says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
The hour is coming,
and now is,
when the dead shall hear
the voice of the Son of God:
and they that hear shall live."

That verse fulfills the promise God made to Abraham when He said, in essence, "Do you believe I can quicken the dead, Abraham?"

What He was saying was, "Abraham, do you believe I can bring a dead spirit from death to life?"

Abraham said, "Yes, I believe You can do that."

God said, "Good, because righteousness is laid to your account. Abraham, you can now call those things that be not as though they were."

Meaning, "You have a spiritually dead spirit, Abraham. But if you believe I can quicken Jesus' spirit from death to life, I am going to call those things that be not, which is your spiritually dead spirit, as though it were already alive. I will put righteousness to your account and treat you as though you already have those rights. They will be paid in full when Jesus comes and I quicken Him from death to life, and then He gives you that life. Right now it is only accounted to you."

"Do you believe I can do that, Abraham?"

Abraham said, "Yes, God. I believe You can do that."

God said, "Good, because I am calling those things that be not as though they were."

Now here is the fulfillment of that promise to Abraham:

"The hour is coming,
and now is,
when the dead shall hear
the voice of the Son of God:
and they that hear shall live."

The dead include Abraham, Moses, Isaac, Jacob, Rachel, Rebekah, and Sarah. The hour is coming, the one I promised Abraham, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God, and they that hear shall live.

Verse 26 gives the reason they will live:

"For as the Father hath life in himself;
so hath he given to the Son
to have life in himself."

As the Father had life within Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself. The Son will give it to them, and they will have life within themselves. God will have fulfilled His promise to Abraham, and you shall live.

Eternal Life Had No Beginning and Therefore Has No End

That means the life I have in me took a journey from inside God, to inside Jesus, to inside me, just as God breathed life into Adam. I have become a new creation.

As the Father had life in Himself, He gave to the Son to have life within Himself.

Listen to me closely. That life was not created at the point you came into existence. He said, "As the Father hath life in himself." It was already there.

If that life was already in the Father, and He gave it to the Son, and the Son turned around and gave it to you, can any of you tell me when the Father had a beginning?

What does that mean? It means that life in Him never had a beginning either. Do you know what that means? It will never have an end.

This is why, when man rebelled in that life, and Adam had it first, there was eternity to deal with. The second Adam received it second, but the first man Adam had that life. When he entered into rebellion with Satan, the nature of that life changed.

Because that life had once been on the inside of God, and because of certain attributes He had to give to humanity that were hard to be trusted with, like willpower, just because man rebelled and was separated from God the Father by nature does not mean that life can be terminated.

That is why there is also an eternity to deal with on the wrong side of the fence.

The part of that life God could correct was the nature.

As the Father had life within Himself, He did not just create the life then. That life already existed. It caused Jesus' spirit to go from death to life. Then when He poured that life into you, it caused your spirit to go from death to life.

That life was not just created. It always was with the Father, and it is on the inside of Him. Now you are His son and His daughter, and you have His life.

Hallelujah.

You are not God. You are His son, and you have that part of Him that gave you His nature.

John 14's Greater Work Is the Administration of the Rebirth

Because we are getting a little deeper than we have ever gone into this, let us go back and look at the greater works verse in John 14.

I do not know why I did not pick up on this chapter long before I did. I looked at John 14:12 for all my born-again experience, and we Pentecostals were always trying to figure out what the greater works would be that we would do.

Jesus said:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
He that believeth on me,
the works that I do
shall he do also;
and greater works than these
shall he do;
because I go unto my Father."

We Pentecostals were always trying to figure out what it was. I remember one time Tim was telling me that this question was asked when he was managing Rex Humbard's ministry, and it jumped out of his spirit: "The greater work will be being born again."

A lot of Pentecostal people believe that men under the Old Testament were born again on accounted righteousness. They were not. That is the whole contention of the law. The curse of the law is that man could not do those things. Animal sacrifices covered the man's sin, but he could not walk free of it until Jesus came.

As Pentecostals, we did not want to hang around the thought that the greater work would be being born again. We wanted to hype ourselves up and get excited about the glory, power, miracles, and the thing that separates us from the rest of the church world: "We are full of the Holy Ghost. We talk with tongues. We have miracles."

Even though people declare the greater works, I have yet to see a person do greater works, per se, than Jesus did, and I am not talking about His work of redemption.

Look at John 14:12 again. Notice the word "works" after "greater" is in italics, which means it was not there. Leaving it out, this is what He says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
He that believeth on me,
the works that I do
shall he do also;
and greater than these
shall he do;
because I go unto my Father."

He left the plural on the works that had already been done under the Old Testament and the Old Covenant. But He says, "greater than these" shall he do, because I go to the Father.

You will administer, preach, and minister a new nature. That is the greater work, because before Jesus rose from the dead, even He could not administer that work.

Hallelujah.

Does that not sound like John 5:20?

"For the Father loveth the Son,
and sheweth him all things that himself doeth:
and he will shew him greater works than these,
that ye may marvel."

That was all the works and miracles done under the Old Testament. He will show Him greater. The greater work He is talking about is the administration of the rebirth, when God offers salvation to the entire world and asks you to carry it.

All the miracles you do will carry a greater work: you will be an able minister of the Spirit. You will be able to administer the faith to be born again.

It is not you who heals a person. It is not you who gives them peace. You preach how to receive it from God, and God does it. It is not you who gives them the new nature inside. You minister that grace, and they reach out and get it from God.

That is the greater work, and you are an able minister to do it.

Glory be to God.

John 16 Pictures the Cross as Travail and the Church as a Man Child Born

I almost got where I was going. I wanted to follow that life from God to Jesus to you. I was going to get people up, pull that life out of God, walk it over to Jesus, pull that same life back out of Him, and put it into you.

That is the only thing God has to use. It is that life. When that life gets free, when you take it out of prison, out of the bondage of religion and false teaching, out of faithlessness, and turn the Holy Ghost loose in it, you are going to walk in exploits.

Do not stay where you are. Outside of the works you do for Him, it would pay you to lock up with God and fellowship with Him, praying in the Holy Ghost. It is a sacrifice, but it is a sacrifice that will turn God loose in you.

Go to John 16. I will just give you a tidbit, a meditation bed. I do not want to leave you thinking, "I already knew that."

John 16:16 says:

"A little while,
and ye shall not see me:
and again,
a little while,
and ye shall see me,
because I go to the Father."

Then some of the disciples said among themselves:

"What is this that he saith unto us,
A little while,
and ye shall not see me:
and again,
a little while,
and ye shall see me:
and,
Because I go to the Father?"

Notice, He said it again. They quoted Him, and He said it. Verse 18 says:

"What is this that he saith,
A little while?
we cannot tell what he saith."

Now Jesus knew they desired to ask Him and said:

"Do ye enquire among yourselves
of that I said,
A little while,
and ye shall not see me:
and again,
a little while,
and ye shall see me?"

That is three times they have said it now.

Then He says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
That ye shall weep and lament,
but the world shall rejoice:
and ye shall be sorrowful,
but your sorrow shall be turned into joy.
A woman when she is in travail hath sorrow,
because her hour is come:
but as soon as she is delivered of the child,
she remembereth no more the anguish,
for joy that a man is born into the world.
And ye now therefore have sorrow:
but I will see you again,
and your heart shall rejoice,
and your joy no man taketh from you.
And in that day ye shall ask me nothing.
Verily, verily, I say unto you,
Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name,
he will give it you."

"That day" He was talking about is our day.

Why would He liken His trip to the cross, His death, resurrection, return to the Father, and the rebirth of the Church to a woman in travail, in labor and anguish? Then she delivers the child, and great joy is in the family because, and I will quote, "a man child is born."

What man child was born into the world?

He is talking about being born. That is right. This first creature, this first birth of the Church, this first child to be born. All the anguish will be gone because this child is born into the world.

He is talking about the rebirth.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

He said in that day you will have your joy, and it is a joy no man can take away from you, because you will become born of God. You will become His son, because that birth has been made possible.